DISCO (6146.T): Briefing: Broadening base of demand, no major concerns on materials sourcing; reiterate Buy

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Disco held its 2Q results briefing from 10:30am JST on October 23, with President Kazuma Sekiya as the key speaker. Within we summarize the key points from management commentary. Regarding equipment for HBM, which has been a major source of concern among investors amid moves toward despecification, management reaffirmed that there has been no change in customers actively purchasing the company's equipment. We also confirmed that the base of demand for Disco's equipment is widening, with OSAT investment appetite growing, and that the company has no particular concerns around materials sourcing. Overall our impression of the briefing was positive.

We note some concerns among investors that the latest increase in production support personnel by Disco could contribute less to shipment growth than in the past. However, we think it is unlikely that the proficiency level of engineers (at present) will affect the future pace of production expansion, given the company's track record of providing production support using more junior employees during COVID-19, when shipment value expanded by c.50% in a few quarters. We see a high likelihood that the consensus earnings expectations will rise going forward, and we reiterate our Buy rating.

Current demand trends

Disco highlighted that equipment demand from OSATs has been increasing recently amid growth in generative AI demand. The company said it opted to increase production support personnel from head office in particular owing to higher shipments of blade dicers. Per Disco, there are no major disparities between applications, and the base of strong demand has widened compared to 1-2 years ago (management also noted that has received equipment inquiries for new fab projects in the US). On the consumables front, the company pointed to an increase in high-value-added products used in front-end process environments, and said ASP is also rising, helping to drive consumables sales and profitability.

Generative AI-related equipment demand

Disco expects similar growth rates for equipment used in both memory (HBM) and logic 2.5D packaging applications, and noted that equipment demand for peripheral devices such as MLCCs and power semiconductors is also expanding. Regarding moves toward layer count changes (de-spec) in HBM, which have been a major source of concern among investors, management reaffirmed its recognition that

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there has been no change in customers actively purchasing Disco's equipment, in part because the overall volume of HBM wafers has increased meaningfully.

Materials sourcing status and company's thoughts on production capacity

Disco said it is making every effort to increase production in response to robust demand. It is concurrently moving ahead with productivity improvements by not only increasing production support personnel but also hiring mid-career employees and fixed-term workers, and shortening equipment takt times. While the company acknowledged it does not have much leeway in terms of materials sourcing, it said that materials are unlikely to become a limiting factor for production expansion going forward, partly because it has built relationships of trust with suppliers.

Exhibit 1: Disco: Earnings summary

DISCO (6146.T)														
(JPY mn)		GSE	GSE	GSE	CoE							GSE	GSE	CoE
Consolidated income statement	3/2026	3/2027	3/2028	3/2029	3/2027	3/2026 1Q	3/2026 2Q	3/2026 3Q	3/2026 4Q	3/2027 1Q	3/2027 2Q	3/2027 3Q	3/2027 4Q	3/2027 3Q
Sales	436,889	602,700	777,300	923,600		89,914	104,623	109,291	133,061	114,308	142,750	155,500	190,142	132,442
Operating profits	184,989	290,800	394,000	478,900		34,480	44,391	47,341	58,777	49,033	67,606	76,500	97,661	58,061
Recurring profits	184,936	290,400	396,800	481,900		33,999	45,466	46,986	58,485	48,441	65,996	77,000	98,963	58,963
Net income	135,521	214,400	293,600	356,600		23,767	32,146	36,726	42,882	34,221	46,145	57,000	77,034	41,534
EBITDA	199,810	307,500	411,700	498,100										
Margins														
Gross profits	70.1%	72.1%	72.5%	72.9%		68.1%	69.5%	71.4%	70.9%	71.3%	71.7%	73.0%	72.3%	
EBITDA	45.7%	51.0%	53.0%	53.9%										
Operating profits	42.3%	48.2%	50.7%	51.9%		38.3%	42.4%	43.3%	44.2%	42.9%	47.4%	49.2%	51.4%	43.8%
Recurring profits	42.3%	48.2%	51.0%	52.2%		37.8%	43.5%	43.0%	44.0%	42.4%	46.2%	49.5%	52.0%	44.5%
Net income	31.0%	35.6%	37.8%	38.6%		26.4%	30.7%	33.6%	32.2%	29.9%	32.3%	36.7%	40.5%	31.4%
R&D	34,156	40,000	45,000	50,000	38,000	7,591	8,070	8,552	9,943	9,366	9,833			
D&A	14,821	16,700	17,700	19,200	16,000	3,420	3,570	3,837	3,994	4,004	3,804			
Capex	32,708	33,000	33,000	40,000	33,000	4,919	7,963	3,688	16,138	3,351	8,959			
EPS (JPY)	1,249.8	1,975.9	2,705.8	3,286.4		219.2	296.5	338.7	395.4	315.5	425.3			382.6
DPS (JPY)	505.0	697.0	1,101.0	1,541.0										
BPS (JPY)	5,422.4	6,876.9	8,885.7	11,071.2										
Assumption														
USD/JPY	151	160	160	160		144	148	156	157	160	159	160	160	151
EUR/JPY	176	182	180	180		166	172	181	184	186	183	180	180	173
Revenue by product <Based on shipment>														
Precision Processing Equipment	274,800	397,900	519,200	618,500		74,400	56,800	69,300	74,200	85,500	93,700	102,000	116,700	96,900
Dicer	137,700	196,500	258,000	305,500		38,900	27,900	31,800	38,900	44,800	49,100	50,000	52,600	47,800
Grinder	122,600	173,800	224,500	268,600		32,200	26,000	34,100	30,400	35,300	38,700	45,000	54,800	42,600
Other related equipment	14,500	27,600	36,700	44,400		3,300	2,900	3,400	4,900	5,400	5,900	7,000	9,300	6,500
Consumables	94,700	128,800	161,000	193,200		21,100	23,100	25,000	25,500	27,200	34,200	36,000	31,400	32,500
Maintenance parts and others	72,900	88,800	106,600	122,600		15,600	17,300	19,300	20,700	21,700	20,800	22,000	24,300	18,700
Total	**442,824**	**615,500**	**786,800**	**934,300**		**111,142**	**96,351**	**113,665**	**121,664**	**135,906**	**148,677**	**160,000**	**170,917**	**149,617**
Revenue by product <Based on customer acceptance>														
Precision Processing Equipment	275,300	394,100	520,500	620,200		54,000	63,800	66,700	86,400	66,200	87,100	100,000	140,800	
Dicer	139,800	196,500	261,000	309,100		31,500	34,500	30,600	39,900	35,400	44,300	50,000	66,800	
Grinder	118,000	164,300	215,200	257,500		19,800	26,200	32,800	41,200	27,400	37,100	42,000	57,800	
Other related equipment	17,500	33,300	44,300	53,600		2,700	3,100	3,300	5,300	3,400	5,700	8,000	16,200	
Consumables	96,100	128,800	161,000	193,200		20,700	23,000	25,100	25,300	27,400	34,300	36,000	31,100	
Maintenance parts and others	65,500	79,800	95,800	110,200		15,300	16,700	17,500	20,000	19,400	20,000	19,500	20,900	
Total	**436,889**	**602,700**	**777,300**	**923,600**		**89,914**	**104,623**	**109,291**	**133,061**	**114,308**	**142,750**	**155,500**	**190,142**	**132,442**

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Disco

Valuation methodology: Our 12-month target price of ¥105,000 is based on our FY3/28E EBITDA estimate, the global SPE sector average EV/EBITDA of 18X, and a sector-relative premium of 50% in view of Disco's high profitability (our TP implies FY3/28E P/E of 39X and P/B of 12X). We are Buy rated.

Key risks: Yen appreciation against the US dollar, slowdown in China demand or tightening of export controls, slowdown in AI-related demand, loss of market share, and deterioration in margins.

6146.T	12m Price Target: **¥105,000**	Price: **¥51,230**	Upside: **105.0%**

Buy

Market cap: ¥5.6tr / $35.3bn
Enterprise value: ¥5.2tr / $33.0bn
3m ADTV: ¥99.9bn / $629.7mn
Japan
Japan Semiconductor, SPE & Precision
M&A Rank: 3
Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: No

GS Forecast

	3/26	3/27E	3/28E	3/29E
Revenue (¥ bn)	436.9	602.7	777.3	923.6
Op. profit (¥ bn)	185.0	290.8	394.0	478.9
Op. profit CoE (¥ bn)	–	–	–	–
EPS (¥)	1,249.5	1,975.9	2,705.8	3,286.4
P/E (X)	37.9	25.9	18.9	15.6
P/B (X)	8.7	7.4	5.8	4.6
Dividend yield (%)	1.1	1.4	2.1	3.0
N debt/EBITDA (ex lease,X)	(1.4)	(1.2)	(1.2)	(1.3)
CROCI (%)	42.0	52.4	58.6	60.4

	6/26	9/26	12/26E	3/27E
EPS (¥)	315.8	425.9	526.1	708.1

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 22 Oct 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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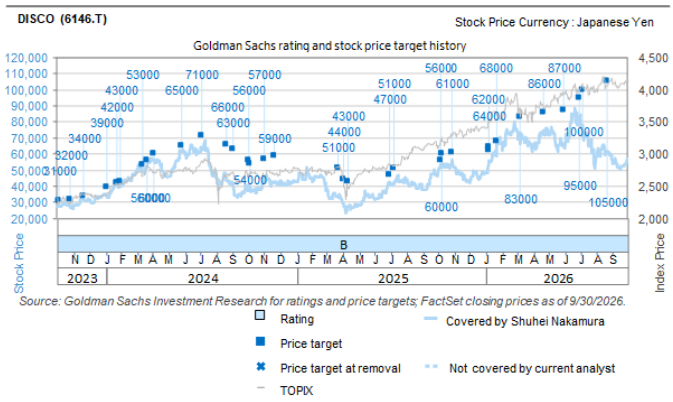
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Target price history table(s)
DISCO (6146.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
23-Aug-26	105,000	61,360
06-Jul-26	100,000	78,000
30-Jun-26	95,000	81,260
31-May-26	87,000	65,090
22-Apr-26	86,000	74,830
09-Mar-26	83,000	66,500
21-Jan-26	68,000	58,570
08-Jan-26	64,000	55,590
06-Jan-26	62,000	54,200
29-Oct-25	61,000	56,390
08-Oct-25	60,000	52,140
06-Oct-25	56,000	54,000
09-Jul-25	51,000	41,290
30-Jun-25	47,000	42,630
13-Apr-25	43,000	27,470
04-Apr-25	44,000	27,635
24-Mar-25	51,000	33,060
21-Nov-24	59,000	42,380
01-Nov-24	57,000	42,810
04-Oct-24	54,000	39,710
02-Oct-24	56,000	37,410
02-Sep-24	63,000	41,350
22-Aug-24	66,000	43,560
04-Jul-24	71,000	64,580
27-May-24	65,000	61,790
04-Apr-24	60,000	56,750
21-Mar-24	56,000	52,960
13-Mar-24	53,000	50,000
31-Jan-24	43,000	40,380
24-Jan-24	42,000	40,730
04-Jan-24	39,000	33,630
21-Nov-23	34,000	32,030
26-Oct-23	32,000	26,960

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